# The AI-First Business

Building lean, leveraged, and future-proof systems.

Alice Bazdikian | AI Educator & Strategist

# The Cost of the Status Quo

**40%**

Increase in productivity for businesses using AI tools.

**30–50%**

Cost savings on repetitive, manual tasks.

**10 Hours**

Time wasted every single week by 60% of small business owners doing work AI could do faster and better.

# AI isn’t coming for your job. Someone using it might.

# The Fatal Mistake

## Bolting AI On

Trying to force AI into existing, broken, manual systems. This is why recent MIT reports show many corporate AI projects are currently failing.

## The AI-First Mindset

Fundamentally reimagining workflows so AI is positioned at the start of the process, not as an afterthought.

# Flipping the Script

First Draft

Final Product

## The Question

For every task, start by asking: Can AI handle this, even partly?

## The Execution

AI generates the first draft. Humans finesse the final product.

## The Trade-off

Let go of manual perfection so AI can help you iterate exponentially faster.

Chaos

Organized SOPs

AI Execution

# Training Your Digital Workforce

- **If your business feels like a plate of spaghetti, you have systems—they just live in your head.**
- **Clearly documented Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) are mandatory for handing work off to AI.**

**Pro Tip:** You don't need to type them out. Use advanced voice mode or audio transcripts to dictate your workflows, and let AI structure the SOP for you.

# Automations vs. AI Agents

**Automations:** The Obedient Intern

Inter

**AI Agents:** The Clever Assistant

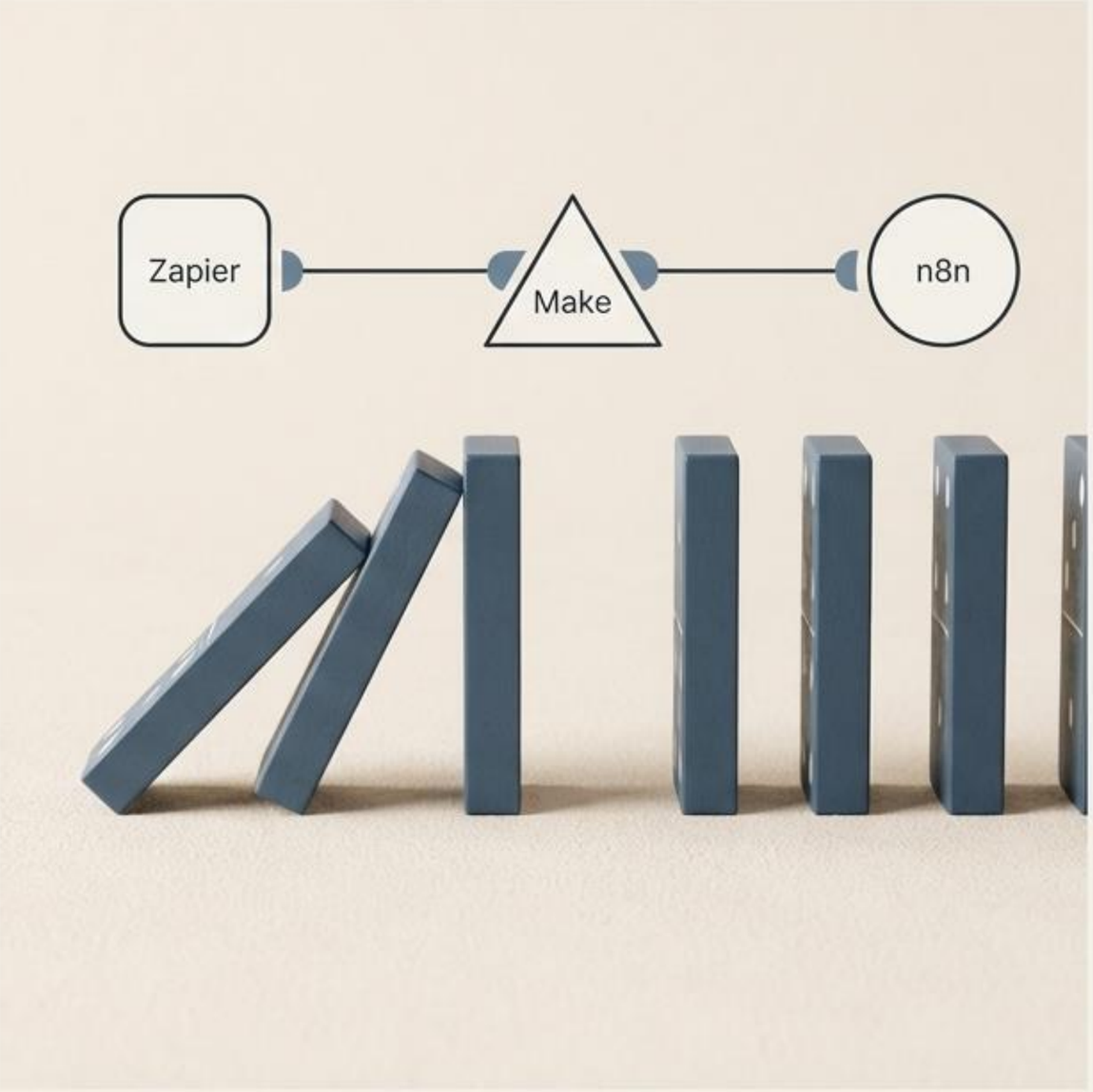
Inter

Alice Bazdikian | AI Educator & Strategist

# The Obedient Intern

Follows a very clear, rigid path. Relies on a defined starting trigger and fixed step-by-step instructions.

**The Limitation**: If a single step breaks or encounters an unexpected variable, the entire automation stops dead in its tracks. It does not stray from the rules.



# The Clever Assistant

Driven by a specific goal or objective rather than a rigid set of rules.

Has the agency to make decisions and independently choose the best tools or paths to accomplish the job.

The Advantage: **Adapts and troubleshoots. If it hits a roadblock, it will logically try a different method to complete the task.**

# The AI-FirstFirst Workflow in Practice

## 1. Intake

Client books via form. Data auto-populates into Airtable or Google Sheets (The Trigger).

## 2. Research

AI Agent activates, reads the intake data, and autonomously researches the lead's business via Perplexity.

## 3. Synthesis

AI drafts a summary of the lead, populates a Notion dashboard, and sends a Slack alert that the brief is ready.

## 4. Delivery

You show up to the call fully prepped, reading deep research you didn't have to manually compile.

# The Universal Adapter

Model Context Protocols (MCPs):
**The bridge that plugs AI directly into your apps, tools, and files.**

AI is no longer isolated; it becomes **aware of your specific business context.**

Capabilities: AI can now **check your calendar for availability**, **read specific Notion dashboards**, or **pull targeted CRM data** entirely on command.

# The Golden Rules of Integration

## Temporary Access

Use tools with permission refresh windows that automatically time out to prevent constant, unchecked access.

## Official Integrations Only

Stick to native connections. Do not trust random, third-party developers.

## Intentional Limits

Don’t plug your entire digital life in. Only share data you would be comfortable handing to a human staff member.

**Note: Official integrations do not use your private data to train public models.*

# The Rise of Custom Tools

The barrier to entry for building proprietary software is now zero.

Using no-code platforms, you can build custom HTML dashboards, ROI calculators, or client portals just by typing a prompt.

The Framework: Start with the end goal. Use screenshots for reference. Build the simple scooter version first before trying to build a rocket ship.

# Start Small, Start Smart

**The Rule:** Do not try to automate your entire business today. Doing so leads to **immediate overwhelm** and system failure.

**The Focus:** Identify the specific bottlenecks. Look for highly repeatable tasks (like back-and-forth scheduling emails or manual lead tracking).

Build mini-workflows to solve **one specific point of friction** at a time.

# The Deeply Human Edge

Let AI and automations handle the boring, repetitive, and manual labor.

Your competitive advantage is not your ability to execute tasks.

In an AI-driven world, your ultimate value lies in **strategy, creativity, and deeply human relationships**.